52. Since the tundra subsoil is frozen throughout the year, burrowing animals cannot live there; and, as the tundra is partly free from snow only during the short summer, conditions for life are poor. Most animals, including reindeer, Arctic hares, Arctic foxes, and wolves, live there in summer only and migrate in autumn. Lemmings, however, stay, feeding on the herbage buried beneath the snow. Polar bears are occasionally found throughout the year along the coasts of the Arctic and northern Pacific oceans.

    The taiga fauna is much richer than that of the tundra. The taiga is the haunt of brown bears, wolves and foxes, gluttons (a kind of wolverine), otters, ermines, sables, lynx, elk, forest reindeer, hares, and several kinds of squirrels.

    The animal life of the steppes differs as much from that of the taiga as from that of the tundra. It includes many burrowing rodents, such as jerboas, marmots, and pikas, and larger mammals, such as numerous antelope. The steppes were the original home of the northern cattle *(Bos taurus),* the horse, and probably the Bactrian (two-humped) camel; few, if any, of those remain as truly wild animals.

    Wild sheep and goats live in the mountains and on the plateau regions to the north of the Himalayas. Tibet is the home of the wild yak, which is in great danger of extinction, although the domesticated yak survives.

53. Micronesia: The region has a tropical marine climate and is part of the Oceania eco-zone. There are five main archipelagos—the Caroline Islands, the Gilbert Islands, the Line Islands, the Mariana Islands, and the Marshall Islands—along with numerous outlying islands.

54. Melanesia: A subregion of Oceania extending from New Guinea island in the southwestern Pacific Ocean to the Arafura Sea, and eastward to Tonga.

    The region includes the four independent countries of Vanuatu, Solomon Islands, Fiji, and Papua New Guinea, as well as the French special collectivity of New Caledonia, and the Indonesian region of Western New Guinea.

55. Polynesia is generally defined as the islands within the Polynesian Triangle, although some islands inhabited by Polynesian people